

2 October 2026

The Chief Editors
Journal of Official Statistics

Dear Editors,

Please consider the enclosed manuscript, “Anytime-valid monitoring of repeated survey estimates under questionnaire redesign: An application to the Business Trends and Outlook Survey”, for publication as a research article in the Journal of Official Statistics.

Statistical offices release short-period estimates from rolling surveys, and users read each release as it appears. Two problems follow that standard tools do not handle: error control under continuous inspection and optional stopping, and the discontinuities produced by questionnaire redesigns. The manuscript proposes a monitor for changes in the growth rate of a published series that addresses both. Its null hypothesis is local linearity with unknown level and slope and a separate unknown level for each questionnaire regime. A group-invariance argument gives a closed-form e-process that is exactly valid for every value of these nuisance parameters, for any size of redesign, using only published design-based standard errors. A simulation study based on the actual sampling errors of the survey examines level, detection delay and robustness, including the effect of understated standard errors. An application to the 56 biweekly waves of the U.S. Census Bureau’s Business Trends and Outlook Survey on business use of artificial intelligence includes the November 2025 wording change, which moved the national estimate by 25.7 standard errors.

The paper suits the journal because it addresses a problem that statistical offices and users of their series face, the interpretation of frequent releases across redesigns, with a method that agencies can adopt by publishing a regime label with each series. The manuscript is original, is not under consideration elsewhere, and has not been published. It has no footnotes or endnotes, follows the journal’s style, and is anonymised, with a separate title page. The analysis data and code are provided so that every number can be reproduced. I have no conflicts of interest to declare and I have not suggested reviewers.

Yours sincerely,

Quang-Vinh Dang
British University Vietnam